TRAVEL

DRIVE

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SPECIFICATIONS

Mercedes-Benz S 450 e

Engine
3.0-litre M256 Evo inline-6 turbo-petrol
Engine Output
326bhp / 540Nm
Electric Motor
120kW / 440Nm
System Output
435bhp / 680Nm
Transmission
9-speed 9G-Tronic automatic
Battery Capacity
22kWh
Electric Range (WLTP)
115 km
0–100 km/h
5.7 seconds
Top Speed
250kmph
Airbags
15
Price
₹2.2 crore

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Beyond performance and technology, the S-Class excels where it matters most: making travel feel remarkably unhurried.





that change the look of the car. The starry grille is a take from the new BEVs, while the signature in the tail lamps, echoed in the headlamps, is a take on the very successful and well-appreciated tail lamps of the E-class. Wheel designs have changed as well, while the front fenders on either side now get a new camera that helps with advanced assistance features.

We start the drive from another of Hamburg's landmarks, The Fontenay. This lakeside hotel, a stone's throw from the heart of the city is spectacular, not only in the way it looks but also for the spectacular views of the sailing regatta taking place on the serene waters of the Alster lake, even while enjoying a gourmet spread at the two Michelin-starred restaurant on top of the hotel.

My drive takes me to the German Riviera, north of Hamburg to another exquisite property, the Weissenhaus Private Nature Luxury Resort, which boasts a 3km-long Baltic sea-front, and a long history of high profile guests and events that includes the G7 foreign ministers meeting.

I cruise out of the city of Hamburg silently, as the car I am driving—and that Mercedes is launching in India—is a plug-in hybrid with an over 100km electric range. It's not long before I'm hurtling down the famed German autobahn, giving the S450e free rein and clocking over 200kmph. Cocooned in luxury with the suspen-